COMPUTER SCIENCE DEPARTMENT **CS 410**

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Activity 3

Case Analysis: Accessibility of Philippine E-Government Websites

Accessibility / Inclusivity Issue Identified	Evidence or Finding from the Article	User/s Who May Be Affected	How Does It Affect User Interaction?	Proposed Improvement
1. Missing Alternative Text (ALT tags) for Non-Text Content	According to Section 5.2, many government websites still fail to provide proper descriptions for images. Table 8 also highlights that image ALT text and decorative image accessibility are among the areas with the lowest compliance, creating challenges for users who depend on screen readers to access online	For citizens who are blind or have low vision, screen readers play an important role in helping them access information on websites.	If images are not labeled correctly, screen reader users may be unable to understand key visual information, limiting their ability to navigate and interact with the website effectively.	To improve accessibility, all informative images should have meaningful ALT text, while purely decorative images should be excluded from screen reader output using empty ALT attributes or CSS-based formatting.

	content.			
2. Low Accessibility in Online Transactions and Service Integration	Figure 5 and Section 5.1 show that government websites have significant gaps in advanced online services. The Transactional stage recorded an average compliance of 40.74%, while the Connected stage showed the lowest performance, with no agency meeting the required standards.	These issues affect all users with disabilities, particularly those with visual, mobility, and dexterity impairments who rely on online government services for accessing information and completing transactions independently.	Because many online services are either unavailable or do not function properly, users are often left with no choice but to visit government offices in person. Problems with online forms, CAPTCHA verification, email confirmations, and digital submission systems can prevent citizens from completing transactions online, making government services less convenient and accessible.	To improve accessibility, government agencies should redesign their online service portals by providing accessible CAPTCHA options, such as audio or text alternatives, supporting accessible e-signatures, sending automated email notifications, and improving system integration. These enhancements can make online transactions easier, more reliable, and more inclusive for all users, especially persons with disabilities.
3. Issues with Website Identity and Visual Branding	Section 4.2 and Section 5.2 show Identity Compliance averaged 78.60%. Five agencies	Cognitive/intellectual disabled users, elderly users, and first-time site visitors.	Missing contact numbers (mobile/fax), feedback channels, or official markers	Standardize agency header/footer design under the Government Website Template

	(DEPED, DFA, DND, NSC, PMS) scored below 70% due to missing contact details, missing feedback forms, and inconsistent visual layouts.		create confusion, making it hard for users to verify website authenticity or seek help when stuck.	Design (GWTD) framework, ensuring visible contact information, feedback forms, and official branding across all pages
4. Inadequate Navigation Structures & Lack of Mobile Responsiveness	Section 5.2 found that although government websites scored highly in navigation, many still lack mobile-friendly designs, mobile applications, and features like breadcrumbs that help users track their location within the site.	Users with physical/motor disabilities, cognitive impairments, and citizens accessing services via mobile devices.	Non-responsive pages force users to scroll horizontally, while unclear site structures make complex agency sub-pages difficult to navigate without losing place.	Develop fully responsive CSS grid layouts optimized for mobile devices, and integrate standardized breadcrumb trails alongside updated site maps.
5. Sub-optimal Content Presentation & Inaccessible Form Controls	Section 5.2 found that content compliance averaged 81.11%; But still many websites still had issues with unclear form labels, poorly labeled multimedia content, and the continued use of outdated	Screen reader users, citizens with cognitive impairments, and keyboard-only users	Unlabeled form fields prevent screen readers from announcing what information is required in a text box. Legacy add-ons block keyboard navigation entirely	To improve accessibility, agencies should provide properly labeled forms, replace outdated web technologies, and include captions and transcripts for all video content to support users with different accessibility

	technologies such as Flash and other legacy plug-ins.			needs.

Final Analysis

While many Philippine government websites generally comply with basic accessibility standards, several issues still make them difficult for some users to navigate and use effectively. No matter how well a system operates when users find it confusing or difficult to use the system can fail to serve. Their system has common problems including missing ALT text on images, unclear form labels, poor navigation, limited mobile responsiveness, and a lack of captions or transcripts for multimedia content. These barriers can significantly affect people with visual, hearing, cognitive, and motor impairments, as well as users who primarily rely on mobile devices to access online services. The government websites are that effective in providing information but many still struggle and face challenges in delivering accessible and user-friendly online services.Their websites have some issues such as difficult navigation, non-functional forms, limited mobile compatibility, and poor accessibility features can make it harder for citizens, especially persons with disabilities (PWDs), to access government services independently. Improving accessibility standards, mobile responsiveness, and regular website evaluations can help create a more inclusive and efficient digital experience for all users.

CS 410: Human Computer Interaction